

character, supporting the local commercial strip as well a major public transport route to and from the City.

The centre continues to fulfill a valuable social role and meeting place for local residents and for the children attending and travelling to the surrounding schools. The diverse local population also includes aged housing within the centre.

The centre is contained within an existing Heritage Conservation Area, reflecting the high heritage significance of the centre. The area maintains a two (2) storey character, with near-complete rows of highly intact Federation terraces (with continuous lateral pitched roofs) and Victorian terraces (with ornate parapet), interspersed with some examples of two storey Interwar and Art Deco apartments.

These buildings of historic character are all of masonry construction, many with painted plaster render with highly decorative finishes. The buildings are mixed-use and maintain a consistent retail ground floor with residential upper storeys and also support awnings over the entire pavement width.

Narrow passages between terraced groups give access to the rear of properties and laneways. Buildings address Bronte Road and do not address the laneways, although some newer buildings have not maintained this approach to the detriment of the Bronte Road streetscape. Numerous buildings within this area possess elements of, or largely intact, original shop fronts. Many others preserve the original entry configuration (i.e. with inset doorway to one side) reconstructed with contemporary materials.

Important views of historic buildings, available from the public domain, include those of the St Mary's Immaculate Catholic Church and associated buildings (a listed State Heritage group), viewed across the community centre at 280-282 Bronte Road.

Appreciation of the high heritage quality of the building stock of this area is compromised by intrusive suspended power lines and the placement above the line of awnings of other built elements such as advertising structures and air conditioning units.

Buildings are a variety of colours in this area which positively contributes to the character of the area. Where a number of adjoining buildings have been painted the same colour the scale and rhythm of the street has been diminished.

The Eastern Suburbs Legion Club is an important community-based use in the centre, although the building is an intrusive element in the existing Conservation Area.

At present the public domain is not particularly well defined, blurring into the adjacent residential areas, particularly at the northern and southern ends of the high street.

Desired Future Character Objectives

- (a) To limit the scale of redevelopment and infill development at the street edge to match the height of the existing heritage parapet façades and roof lines, with setbacks to further levels where appropriate.
- (b) To ensure that the design of infill development remains consistent with the regular division of frontages, where regular divisions occur.
- (c) To ensure an integrated approach and consistent treatment to the conservation of terrace groups of buildings of historic character.
- (d) To minimise 'visual clutter' through control of peripheral building elements.